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Apache Pig Tutorial – Part 1

posted in [Apache Pig](#), [Hadoop](#), [HOWTO](#), [Programming](#) on **December 26, 2013** by **Rohit**

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Apache Pig is a tool used to analyze large amounts of data by representing them as data flows. Using the PigLatin scripting language operations like ETL (Extract, Transform and Load), adhoc data analysis and iterative processing can be easily achieved.

Pig is an abstraction over MapReduce. In other words, all Pig scripts internally are converted into Map and Reduce tasks to get the task done. Pig was built to make programming MapReduce applications easier. Before Pig, Java was the only way to process the data stored on HDFS.

Pig was first built in Yahoo! and later became a top level Apache project. In this series of we will walk through the different features of pig using a sample dataset.

Dataset

The dataset that we are using here is from one of my projects called **Flicksery**. Flicksery is a Netflix Search Engine. The dataset is a simple text (movies_data.csv) file lists movie names and its details like release year, rating and runtime.

A sample of the dataset is as follows:

```
1, The Nightmare Before Christmas, 1993, 3.9, 4568
2, The Mummy, 1932, 3.5, 4388
3, Orphans of the Storm, 1921, 3.2, 9062
4, The Object of Beauty, 1991, 2.8, 6150
5, Night Tide, 1963, 2.8, 5126
6, One Magic Christmas, 1985, 3.8, 5333
7, Muriel's Wedding, 1994, 3.5, 6323
8, Mother's Boys, 1994, 3.4, 5733
9, Nosferatu: Original Version, 1929, 3.5, 5651
10, Nick of Time, 1995, 3.4, 5333
```

All code and data for this post can be downloaded from [github](#). The file has a total of **49590** records.

Installing Pig

Download Pig

```
$ wget http://mirror.symnds.com/software/Apache/pig/pig-0.12.0
/pig-0.12.0.tar.gz
```

Untar

```
$ tar xvzf pig-0.12.0.tar.gz
```

Rename to folder for easier access:

```
$ mv pig-0.12.0 pig
```

Update .bashrc to add the following:

```
export PATH=$PATH:/home/hduser/pig/bin
```

Pig can be started in one of the following two modes:

1. Local Mode
2. Cluster Mode

Using the '-x local' options starts pig in the local mode whereas executing the pig command without any options starts in Pig in the cluster mode. When in local mode, pig can access files on the local file system. In cluster mode, pig can access files on HDFS.

Restart your terminal and execute the pig command as follows:

To start in Local Mode:

```
$ pig -x local
2013-12-25 20:16:26,258 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.Main - Apache
Pig version 0.12.0 (r1529718) compiled Oct 07 2013, 12:20:14
2013-12-25 20:16:26,259 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.Main - Logging
error messages to: /home/hduser/pig/myscripts/pig_1388027786256.log
2013-12-25 20:16:26,281 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.impl.util.Utils
- Default bootup file /home/hduser/.pigbootup not found
2013-12-25 20:16:26,381 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.HExecutionEngine -
Connecting to hadoop file system at: file:///
grunt>
```

To start in Cluster Mode:

```
$ pig
2013-12-25 20:19:42,274 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.Main - Apache
Pig version 0.12.0 (r1529718) compiled Oct 07 2013, 12:20:14
2013-12-25 20:19:42,274 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.Main - Logging
error messages to: /home/hduser/pig/myscripts/pig_1388027982272.log
2013-12-25 20:19:42,300 [main] INFO org.apache.pig.impl.util.Utils
- Default bootup file /home/hduser/.pigbootup not found
2013-12-25 20:19:42,463 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.HExecutionEngine -
Connecting to hadoop file system at: hdfs://localhost:54310
2013-12-25 20:19:42,672 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.HExecutionEngine -
Connecting to map-reduce job tracker at: hdfs://localhost:9001
grunt>
```

This command presents you with a grunt shell. The grunt shell allows you to execute PigLatin statements to quickly test out data flows on your data step by step without having to execute complete scripts. Pig is now installed and we can go ahead and start using Pig to play with data.

Pig Latin

To learn Pig Latin, let's question the data. Before we start asking questions, we need the data to be accessible in Pig.

Use the following command to load the data:

```
grunt> movies = LOAD '/home/hduser/pig/myscripts/movies_data.csv'
USING PigStorage(',') as (id,name,year,rating,duration);
```

The above statement is made up of two parts. The part to the left of “=” is called the relation or alias. It looks like a variable but you should note that this is not a variable. When this statement is executed, no MapReduce task is executed.

Since our dataset has records with fields separated by a comma we use the keyword USING PigStorage(',').

Another thing we have done in the above statement is giving the names to the fields using the ‘as’ keyword.

Now, let's test to see if the alias has the data we loaded.

```
grunt> DUMP movies;
```

Once, you execute the above statement, you should see lot of text on the screen (partial text shown below).

```

2013-12-25 23:03:04,550 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.tools.pigstats.ScriptState - Pig features used in
the script: UNKNOWN
2013-12-25 23:03:04,633 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.newplan.logical.optimizer.LogicalPlanOptimizer -
{RULES_ENABLED=[AddForEach, ColumnMapKeyPrune,
DuplicateForEachColumnRewrite, GroupByConstParallelSetter,
ImplicitSplitInserter, LimitOptimizer, LoadTypeCastInserter,
MergeFilter, MergeForEach, NewPartitionFilterOptimizer,
PartitionFilterOptimizer, PushDownForEachFlatten, PushUpFilter,
SplitFilter, StreamTypeCastInserter], RULES_DISABLED=
[FilterLogicExpressionSimplifier]}
2013-12-25 23:03:04,748 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.mapReduceLayer.MRCompi
ler - File concatenation threshold: 100 optimistic? false
2013-12-25 23:03:04,805 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.mapReduceLayer.MultiQu
eryOptimizer - MR plan size before optimization: 1
2013-12-25 23:03:04,805 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.backend.hadoop.executionengine.mapReduceLayer.MultiQu
eryOptimizer - MR plan size after optimization: 1
2013-12-25 23:03:04,853 [main] INFO
org.apache.pig.tools.pigstats.ScriptState - Pig script settings are
added to the job

.....

HadoopVersion PigVersion UserId StartedAt FinishedAt Features
1.1.2 0.12.0 hduser 2013-12-25 23:03:04 2013-12-25 23:03:05 UNKNOWN

Success!

Job Stats (time in seconds):
JobId Alias Feature Outputs
job_local_0001 movies MAP_ONLY file:/tmp/temp-1685410826
/tmp1113990343,

Input(s):
Successfully read records from: "/home/hduser/pig/myscripts
/movies_data.csv"

Output(s):
Successfully stored records in: "file:/tmp/temp-1685410826

```

```
/tmp1113990343"

Job DAG:
job_local_0001

.....

(49586,Winter Wonderland,2013,2.8,1812)
(49587,Top Gear: Series 19: Africa Special,2013,,6822)
(49588,Fireplace For Your Home: Crackling Fireplace with
Music,2010,,3610)
(49589,Kate Plus Ei8ht,2010,2.7,)
(49590,Kate Plus Ei8ht: Season 1,2010,2.7,)
```

It is only after the DUMP statement that a MapReduce job is initiated. As we see our data in the output we can confirm that the data has been loaded successfully.

Now, since we have the data in Pig, let's start with the questions.

List the movies that having a rating greater than 4

```
grunt> movies_greater_than_four = FILTER movies BY
(float)rating>4.0;
grunt> DUMP movies_greater_than_four;
```

The above statements filters the alias movies and store the results in a new alias `movies_greater_than_four`. The `movies_greater_than_four` alias will have only records of movies where the rating is greater than 4.

The DUMP command is only used to display information onto the standard output. If you need to store the data to a file you can use the following command:

```
grunt> store movies_greater_than_four into '/user/hduser
/movies_greater_than_four';
```

In this post we got a good feel of Apache Pig. We loaded some data and executed some basic commands to query it. The next post will dive deeper into Pig Latin where we will learn some advanced techniques to do data analysis.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



ROHIT MENON

I am an author and software developer who loves to learn and build new things. To share my learning I blog here and have also built Hadoop Screencasts (www.hadoopscreencasts.com), that hosts screencasts on Apache Hadoop and its components.

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AMP

January 31, 2014 at 12:28 pm

Hi Rohit,

Thanks for the beginners article on Pig.

How to get the 'movies_data.csv' file to proceed?

REPLY ↓



AMP

January 31, 2014 at 12:30 pm

Edit–

Oh got it ... was available in second article.

REPLY ↓

**GREAT_RAISIN***April 7, 2014 at 5:52 am*

Hey Rohit, loved this post. It's a very nice intro to Pig for noobs. Just one thing – when you're storing data to a file, you use 'into' and not 'in'.

R E P L Y ↓**SUSHIL***April 8, 2014 at 10:29 pm*

Very Good Site

R E P L Y ↓**NK***April 12, 2014 at 1:11 am*

Very good introduction.
I had one correction that I wanted to point out.

The below line needs to have INTO instead IN

```
grunt> store movies_greater_than_four in '/user/hduser  
/movies_greater_than_four';
```

R E P L Y ↓**AMITABH_RANJAN***July 9, 2014 at 6:51 pm*

Thanks sir, Thanks very much

R E P L Y ↓**NARENDRA***August 18, 2014 at 6:56 pm*

Good Work man.. Keep going and inspire people...

R E P L Y ↓**SUNEEL***August 27, 2014 at 7:08 am*



Having knowledge is different, presenting in such a way of easy understanding and leaves a print of content in reader mind is the thing!..

You Rockzz!...

R E P L Y ↓



ASHU

October 18, 2014 at 9:13 pm

Thanks very much!

R E P L Y ↓



SUMIT SAINI

December 3, 2014 at 5:32 am

Hello Rohit,
That's good thought and share with us

R E P L Y ↓



POORNIMA

December 8, 2014 at 8:26 am

Excellent tutorial,,Helps to understand the basics very clearly.

R E P L Y ↓



ARVIND

December 14, 2014 at 8:27 am

I am wondering , that when we do a DUMP the MAP REDUCE function runs and we get the output of file as display. Does that also store the file on HDFS? If no the how do we store the file on HDFS via FIG.

R E P L Y ↓



ROHIT MENON

January 3, 2015 at 7:53 am

Hey Arvind, You can use STORE to store files to HDFS.

R E P L Y ↓



**MONICA****February 4, 2015 at 12:56 pm**

Very good post. First post I found on web w.r.t. PIG, which was so easily understandable 😊

R E P L Y ↓**GUBS****February 13, 2015 at 8:42 pm**

Very Nice article. I know its repeated. I felt i have to. Thank you.

R E P L Y ↓**NAGU****March 11, 2015 at 4:47 pm**

Easy to understand for beginners.Thank you

R E P L Y ↓**ROHIT****March 22, 2015 at 5:32 pm**

Eloquently explained 😊

R E P L Y ↓

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<a href="" title=""> <abbr title=""> <acronym title=""> <b> <blockquote  
cite=""> <cite> <code> <del datetime=""> <em> <i> <q cite=""> <strike>  
<strong>
```

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